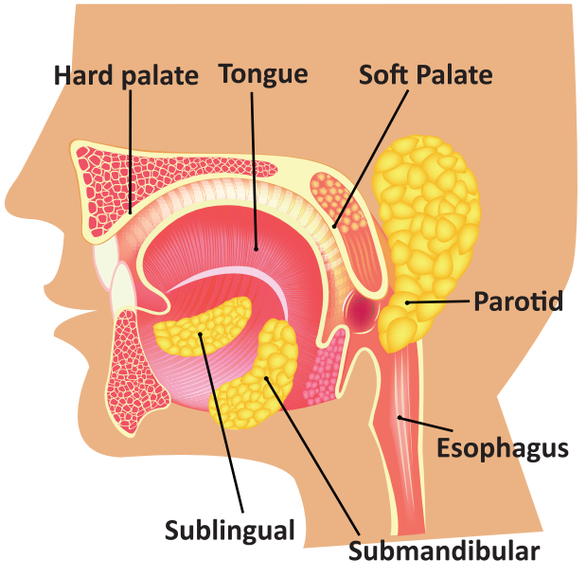
- Saliva contains **two enzymes. Ptyalin** and **Maltase** which converts starchy foods into sugars.
- Saliva helps in the sensation of taste.
- It helps in the excretion of certain substances. Ex: mercury, lead.



iii. Oesophagus

The esophagus is a muscular tube which conveys food from oral cavity to stomach.

iv Stomach

The stomach is a J shaped expanded bag, located left side of the midline between the oesophagus and small intestine.

The stomach is divided into three regions: the fundus, the body and the pylorus.

The functions of the stomach include:

- The short-term storage of ingested food.
- Mechanical breakdown of food by churning and mixing motions.
- Temporary storage allowing time for the digestive enzymes like pepsin to act.
- Limited absorption of water, alcohol and some fat soluble drugs.
- Preparation of iron for absorption further along the tract.

v. Small intestine

The small intestine is composed of the duodenum, jejunum, and ileum. It averages approximately 6m in length. The lining of the small intestine is made up of numerous permanent folds, numerous villi and microvilli.

Functions of Small Intestine

- Secretion of intestinal juice and hormones.
- Completion of chemical digestion of carbohydrates, protein and fats.
- Provide protection from infection by microbes.
- Digestion and absorption of nutrients .

v. Large intestine

The large intestine is horse-shoe shaped and extends around the small intestine like a frame.

Functions of Large Intestine

- Absorption of water, by osmosis, continuous until the semi solid consistency of stools is achieved.
- Mineral salts, vitamins and some drugs are also absorbed.
- It has certain types of bacteria which synthesize Vitamin K and folic acid.
- It helps in mass movement of fecal mass.

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